

action with no dice in the dice pool. For more information about health, healing, and sources of damage, see Chapter Six: Systems and Drama.

Bruised: (0) The character is only bruised and has no action penalties.

Hurt: (–1) The character is mildly hurt, and his movement is unhindered.

Injured: (–1) The character has a minor injury and little hindrance to his movement.

Wounded: (–2) The character is seriously wounded. He can walk but not run.

Mauled: (–2) The character has substantial damage and can barely hobble.

Crippled: (–5) The character is severely injured. He can no longer stand, only drag himself on the ground.

Incapacitated: The character is unconscious and incapable of any actions.

Experience

During the course of a chronicle, characters — much like players over the course of their lives — learn from their mistakes and grow. Change is inevitable, especially for the mercurial and dreamlike fae.

The most important changes to a **Changeling** character aren't reflected on the character sheet (or, if they are, they don't cost points to notate). Characters learn, love, suffer, and (perhaps) triumph over the course of a chronicle. Indeed, the chronicle is *about* those changes.

In addition, though, characters improve themselves in skills magical or mundane. A system of rewards, called *experience points*, is used to reflect these more quantitative changes. Experience points reflect the Traits that a changeling hones as time passes.

At the end of each chapter, the Storyteller awards experience points to each character. The players then write down how many experience points the character earned. Between stories (or, if the Storyteller agrees, between chapters), players may spend their characters' experience points to purchase or increase Traits.

Experience points can be used to improve Attributes, to acquire new Abilities or enhance ones the character already has, to raise existing Arts and Realms or purchase new ones, or to increase Willpower and Glamour. Backgrounds may not be purchased through experience points, though they may be acquired through roleplaying if, for example, the character makes a new friend, acquires a windfall, or steals a Treasure. The costs for all of these different changes vary greatly, as shown on the chart on p. 176.

Experience points are spent to increase Traits (most of them, at least; see below). The chart in the sidebar shows the various costs for each kind of Trait. Most costs are based on the Trait's current rating multiplied by a particular number. If, for example, a player wanted to increase her Kenning from 3 to 4, it would cost six points. Gaining the first dot in a new Trait has a flat cost. If the player wants to gain a new Ability

the character doesn't currently possess, she pays three points to get the first dot.

The Storyteller is the final arbiter of how many experience points each character receives, as well as which Traits may be raised. Accordingly, the Storyteller should oversee where experience points are spent. Players may wish to put points into areas that don't honestly reflect what the character has learned during the story or chronicle, in which case the Storyteller can veto their actions. For example, if a character did not use his Melee Ability at all during a story, he could not have improved it, and thus the Storyteller should not allow him to increase the number of dots in that Ability. Note that a character does not have to use his Traits *successfully* to be eligible for an increase. We often learn more from failure than from success, and the fae are no different.

As Storyteller, try to be fair about experience-point expenditure, and never take things to the point at which the player feels he has no control over the character any longer. Ask the players what they feel their characters learned before awarding any points, and use that as part of the basis for giving them experience points. These limitations are put forth to add a level of reality to the game. If the changes in the character are completely random, the impact is lost. Weave the changes into the course of events, and make the changes reflect what has occurred.

No Trait may be increased by more than one point during the course of a story. Vast changes in Traits take time, and the game should reflect that limitation.

New Traits

Increasing existing Traits can be done fairly readily, so long as the character uses or practices the Trait in question. Learning new Traits, however, is a little more difficult. Learning an entirely new Skill, Knowledge, Art, or Realm requires some tutoring and study, in addition to the required experience-point expenditure. This study can be simple (a few days training with a friend to learn the basics of Melee) or brutally difficult (a quest into the Near Dreaming to discover the principles behind the Oneiromancy Art), but it must always be accomplished. Having the Mentor Background helps, but even a mentor can teach only what she herself knows.

Storytellers: Do not allow players to neglect this requirement! Particularly for more esoteric Traits such as Arts, pursuit of new knowledge — and payment for the same — can lead to all manner of incredible stories.

Awarding Experience Points

Awarding experience points is a double-edged sword. As a Storyteller, you can hurt your chronicle by giving away too many as well as too few. If you give more to some players than you do to others, you might seem as if you're playing favorites, and you also risk unbalancing the game. However, the characters who do the most, who take the risks and learn from their mistakes instead of simply sitting on the sidelines, deserve the experience points to reflect the changes they're going through. The rules